civil society leader who commented, "If we are not allowed to practice our culture, educate in our language, and express our religion, one day we will no longer be Kachin." Both civil society and non-state Kachin leaders interviewed said that 'the Burman elite' and military are trying to homogenize identity to achieve the ideological ideal of a strong nation-state. As a Kachin civil society leader said, "The Tatmadaw are fighting for what they believe is nation-building, but in so doing they become a predatory force."

If individual Kachin citizens and civil society representatives express concerns about discrimination and denial of equal citizenship rights, the Kachin non-state actors we interviewed all articulated their contemporary grievances in terms of Panglong, as discussed above. One was particularly strident, suggesting that Panglong offered them a place in a union between equal partners, but that they have been treated as subjects ever since. Seng Maw Lahpai (2013, p. 298) elaborates this grievance as being denied self-determination in terms of control over the administration of their region (systems of governance, population, and territory), including the resources that could provide independent revenue streams, thus limiting financial dependency on Naypyitaw and maximizing their ability to deliver development opportunities to the Kachin people.

The intense passion about their inability to exercise governance over what they consider to be 'their' communities and territory is very strong. As a KIO spokesman said:

> We continue to emphasize Panglong because that was where we signed a formal agreement with the Burmans. We invested our land to build this nation. We are here with our own land. When they breached the Panglong agreement, they tried to occupy our land and dominate and control us. We are still asking for Panglong to be honoured, but if they do not recognize Panglong, the land should revert to pre-Panglong terms, which did not put the land automatically into the Union.

Or put another way by a foreign consultant:

> The Burman elite adopted the role of big brother, taking on the responsibility and burdens of the minorities in a patron-client sort of relationship to help them develop. The Burmans invited the minorities to come under their umbrella, and they are meant to be pleased with this — but the ethnic minority leaders want to be patrons in their own right! The Kachin elite's grievance about inequality is not so much regarding inequalities in citizenship or development, as in position and roles in governance.